

Fatema Akhter Mitu

Curriculum Vitae

Department of Communication Sciences & Disorders • Louisiana State University

Baton Rouge, LA 70803 • fmitu1@lsu.edu

EDUCATION

- Ph.D., expected Spring 2027 **Communication Sciences & Disorders**, Louisiana State University
Dissertation: *Understanding Parental Verbal Responsivity: Linking Direct Observation and Parent Report Measures in Diverse Cultural Contexts*
Advisor: Eileen K. Haebig, Ph.D., CCC-SLP
- M.Sc., 2018 **Social Science Interdisciplinary**, University at Buffalo, SUNY
Concentration: Communicative Disorders & Sciences
Project: *Challenges and perceptions of different professionals in the provision of assistive devices (AAC) with AAC users*
- B.Sc., 2009 **Speech & Language Therapy**, University of Dhaka, Bangladesh
Thesis: *A comparative study of commercially available thickening agents to Bangladeshi-available thickening agents for representation of thickened fluid consistencies, taste, and texture*

CLINICAL EXPERIENCE

- 05/2010 – 07/2013 **Clinical Speech & Language Therapist**
Department of Speech & Language Therapy, Centre for the Rehabilitation of the Paralysed (CRP), Savar, Dhaka, Bangladesh.
- 05/2009 – 05/2010 **Clinical Internship**
Pediatric Unit, Adult Unit, and Special School Setting, Centre for the Rehabilitation of the Paralysed (CRP), Savar, Dhaka, Bangladesh.

GRANTS & TRAVEL AWARDS

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| 2025 | Juneau Child Language Research Grant | \$2,000 |
| 2025 | LSU Graduate Student Association Student Travel Award | \$200 |
| 2025 | LSU College of Humanities and Social Sciences Graduate Student Conference Travel Fund | \$400 |
| 2025 | LSU Department of Communication Sciences and Disorders Ph.D. Student Travel Award | \$400 |
| 2026 | ASHA Research Mentoring-Pair Travel Award (RMPTA) | \$750 |

PUBLICATIONS

Peer-Reviewed Journal Articles

1. **Mitu, F., & Haebig, E.** (2025). The influence of social word features on early word learning in autistic and non-autistic children. *Behavioral Sciences*, 16(1), 26. <https://doi.org/10.3390/bs16010026>

Manuscripts in Preparation

1. **Mitu, F., Haebig, E., & Su, W.-C.** (in preparation). *Do parent-reported responsivity measures reflect what we see? Alignment with observed parent verbal responsivity* [Manuscript in preparation]. Department of Communication Sciences and Disorders, Louisiana State University.

CONFERENCE PRESENTATIONS

Refereed Conference Oral Presentations

1. **Mitu, F.** (2009). *Autism and speech and language therapy*. Oral presentation, 3rd South Asian Regional Conference on Autism, Dhaka, Bangladesh.

Refereed Conference Poster Presentations

1. **Mitu, F., & Haebig, E.** (2026). *The influence of social word features on early word learning in autistic and non-autistic children*. Poster presented at the Meeting on Language in Autism, Atlanta, GA.
2. **Green, R., Thomas, R., Reed, S., Davis, R., Mitu, F., Haebig, E., & Su, W.-C.** (2026). *The roles of parental stress and children's adaptive functioning on parent-child interactions and developmental outcomes*. Poster presented at the International Congress of Infant Studies (ICIS) 2026, Panama City, Panama.
3. **Mitu, F., & Haebig, E.** (2023). *The association between social ratings of words and early word learning in young autistic children*. Poster accepted for presentation at the American Speech-Language-Hearing Association Convention, Boston, MA. (Withdrawn)
4. **Mitu, F.** (2013). *A comparative study of commercially available thickening agents to Bangladeshi-available thickening agents for representation of thickened fluid consistencies, taste, and texture*. Poster accepted for presentation at the 3rd Congress of the European Society for Swallowing Disorders, Malmö, Sweden.

Non-Refereed Conference Oral Presentations

1. **Mitu, F., & Haebig, E.** (2026). *Bilingualism and language development: Myths, evidence, and guidance for parents, caregivers, and teachers*. C.W. Austin Learning Disabilities Conference, Baton Rouge, LA.
2. **Mitu, F., & Haebig, E.** (2025). *Evidence-based strategies to support language development in children with language learning disorders*. C.W. Austin Learning Disabilities Conference, Baton Rouge, LA.

Invited Talks

1. **Mitu, F.** (2026). *Autism and early word learning*. Invited oral presentation, Diverse Psych Day, Department of Psychology, Louisiana State University, Baton Rouge, LA.

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

07/2022 – Present	Graduate Research Assistant Language and Neurodevelopmental Trajectories Lab, Louisiana State University, Baton Rouge, LA.
09/2018 – 02/2019	Research Assistant Institute of Autism Research, Canisius College, Buffalo, NY.
06/2018 – 08/2018	Volunteer Research Assistant Summer MAXout Program, Institute of Autism Research, Canisius College, Buffalo, NY.
2014 – 2015	Volunteer Lab Member Communication and Assistive Device Laboratory, University at Buffalo, NY.
08/2003 – 05/2004	Research Assistant (pre-undergraduate) Doctoral study of Dr. Melanie Adams: <i>The Management of Feeding Difficulties in Children with Cerebral Palsy in Bangladesh</i> (Ph.D. completed at University College London, UK).

RESEARCH MENTORING EXPERIENCE

Mentored Undergraduate Research Projects

1. Kasuli, C., Mitu, F., Su, W.-C., & Haebig, E. (2026). Do parent-reported scores align with observation-based coding of parent responsivity? Poster presented at LSU Discover Day, Louisiana State University, Baton Rouge, LA.
2. Delamain, J., Mitu, F., Su, W.-C., & Haebig, E. (2026). Examining the agreement between parent-reported and directly coded parent behaviors of scaffolding child language skills. Poster presented at LSU Discover Day, Louisiana State University, Baton Rouge, LA.

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Instructor of Record

Spring 2024	Instructor , COMD 2050: Introduction to Language Department of Communication Sciences & Disorders, Louisiana State University.
Spring 2023, Fall 2022, Spring 2022	Instructor , COMD 2081: Introduction to Communication Disorders Department of Communication Sciences & Disorders, Louisiana State University.

Lab Instructor

Fall 2026	Lab Instructor , COMD 4380: Speech and Language Development Department of Communication Sciences & Disorders, Louisiana State University.
Fall 2025	Lab Instructor , COMD 4380: Speech and Language Development Department of Communication Sciences & Disorders, Louisiana State University.

Graduate Teaching Assistant

Spring 2026	Grading Teaching Assistant , COMD4382: Basic Language Disorders of Children Department of Communication Sciences & Disorders, Louisiana State University.
Spring 2025	Grading Teaching Assistant , COMD4382: Basic Language Disorders of Children; COMD 4153: Acoustics of Speech and Hearing Department of Communication Sciences & Disorders, Louisiana State University.
Spring 2023	Grading Teaching Assistant , COMD4153: Acoustics of Speech and Hearing Department of Communication Sciences & Disorders, Louisiana State University.

Earlier Teaching Appointments

2012 – 2013	Co-Trainer , National Level Training Program Organized by the International Centre for the Advancement of Community-Based Rehabilitation (ICACBR), Queen's University, Canada; conducted in Dhaka, Bangladesh. Delivered 152 hours of training across four modules: Inter-Professional Collaboration in Disability and Maternal/Child Health; Saving Lives - Preventing Disability; Inclusive Inter-Professional Approach to MCHD; and Promoting Rights to Safe Motherhood and Health for All.
2009	Teaching Assistant to Visiting Professor Dr. Beverly Joffe (La Trobe University, Australia) SLT 303: Child Speech/Language Delay or Disorder. Department of Speech & Language Therapy, University of Dhaka, Bangladesh.

PROFESSIONAL DEVELOPMENT & SERVICE

Peer Review

2025	Co-Reviewer , a manuscript for <i>Autism & Developmental Language Impairments</i> .
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Volunteer Experience

2022	Student Volunteer , American Speech-Language-Hearing Association (ASHA) Convention.
2018	Volunteer Research Assistant , Summer MAXout Program, Institute of Autism Research, Canisius College, Buffalo, NY.

Continuing Education & Training

2013	1-Week Observational Placement Department of Speech and Language Pathology, Boston University. Carl J. Lamb Elementary School, Sanford, ME.
2012 – 2013	8-month online course , Disability in the Community, Community-Based Rehabilitation, and International Development, with specialization in Disability, Maternal and Child Health. Queen's University, Canada.

Professional Service

2026 – Present	Member , Louisiana Speech-Language-Hearing Association
2012 – 2013	Member , National Technical Guidance Committee on Autism and Other Neurodevelopmental Disabilities (this committee works for Global Autism Public Health Bangladesh).

WORK HISTORY

Clinical & Departmental Leadership

03/2011 – 08/2013	Department Head of Speech and Language Therapy Centre for the Rehabilitation of the Paralysed, Dhaka, Bangladesh.
03/2011 – 08/2013	Clinical Supervisor (15 interns per year) Department of Speech & Language Therapy, University of Dhaka, Bangladesh.
04/2011 – 03/2012	Clinical Supervisor , 4th-year students Department of Speech & Language Therapy, University of Dhaka, Bangladesh.
03/2009 – 04/2009	Speech and Language Therapy Leader Operation Cleft Australia Foundation.

Training Delivered

05/2010 – 07/2013	Trainer , Autism Training for Teachers and Parents Special Schools across Dhaka and six other districts, Bangladesh.
10/2012	Trainer , 3-day Hands-on Practice on Autism Chittagong Medical College, Chittagong, Bangladesh.
05/2012	Trainer , Doctors' Training on Autism Bangabandhu Sheikh Mujib Medical University, Dhaka, Bangladesh.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Software	R, SPSS, SALT (Systematic Analysis of Language Transcripts)
Languages	Bengali (native), English (fluent), Hindi (conversational)